Event Technology Awards: AI Edition

Filipzik, VOK DAMS Events GmbH, Jan

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Most Innovative AI Application in Events

Celebrating groundbreaking AI ideas or applications that push the industry forward and deliver clear, creative impact.

Questions / Answers

ENTRANT DETAILS

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COMPANY INFORMATION

Company / Organisation Name
VOK DAMS Events GmbH

Product Name (optional)
Digital Doppelgänger

Company profile
VOK DAMS worldwide is a leading international communications agency for events and live marketing. At 19 locations worldwide, around 300 highly skilled professionals create and produce brand experiences for corporate and public events, trade fairs, roadshows and showrooms. Founded in 1975 and owner-managed ever since, VOK DAMS has a wide range of renowned clients worldwide, such as BMW, Bayer, L'Oréal, Lamborghini, Porsche and SAP, for which they create compelling and result driven live, digital and hybrid productions. The agency's projects are regularly honored by well-respected juries worldwide with creative awards, such as Red Dot, Golden Award of Montreux, Gala, beaworld, Galaxy, BrandEx, EX Awards, and the German Prize for Business Communication. VOK DAMS has offices in Berlin, Frankfurt, Hamburg, Munich, Stuttgart and its headquarters in Wuppertal. In addition, there are international offices in Barcelona, Beijing, Shanghai, Hong Kong, Bordeaux, London, Tallinn, Vienna, Prague, New York, Philadelphia, Sao Paulo and Dubai.

YOUR PRODUCT

Questions / Answers

Description of your technology

Digital Doppelgänger turn event planning from assumption-based decision-making into simulation-driven stratey. It is an AI-powered decision intelligence solution that enables organizations to simulate audience reactions before any communication or events goes live. It allows you to test how audiences will react, before committing budget, time and production resources.

The system creates psychologically grounded behavioral models of real audiences. Instead of delivering a single answer, it generates decision-tested scenarios that make trade-offs, risks and likely outcomes transparent. This replaces a core weakness in the industry: Rather than relying only on assumptions, post-event feedback or costly upfront research, Digital Doppelgänger close this gap and allow organizations to test concepts, messages, formats and strategic choices in advance. The system shows how different audience types respond, where engagement is created, where friction may occur and which elements are most likely to drive action, trust or disengagement.

At its core, the solution combines behavioral science, structured audience modeling and AI-powered simulation. Each Digital Doppelgänger reflects stable human drivers such as values, motivations, decision patterns and context-specific expectations. These models are applied to specific use cases, for example live events, trade shows, internal communication formats or brand experiences. You can compare alternatives, challenge assumptions and improve decision quality before production begins. Instead of waiting for feedback after execution, you can evaluate strategic options based on likely behavioral responses during the planning phase.

The product was built to solve a common problem in communication and event design: critical decisions are often made before organizations truly know how their audiences will react. Existing methods either provide feedback too late or require expensive and time-consuming research. Digital Doppelgänger close this gap by adding a practical simulation layer between strategy and execution. The result is a fundamental shift from assumption-based planning to simulation-driven decision-making, reducing uncertainty, accelerating alignment and improving decision quality. Instead of asking “Will this work?”, you can now test it.

Unlike persona-based approached or prompt-driven simulations, Digital Doppelgänger are built on structured weighted bahavioral models that define decision logic independently from the AI system generating the output. Digital Doppelgänger do not replace creative thinking. They strengthen it you allowing ideas to be tested, refined and validated before exection.

TECHNOLOGY DESCRIPTION

Explain how the AI works in your solution?

Digital Doppelgänger combine large language models with a structured behavioral framework to simulate how a specific audience thinks and decides. The AI operates within defined behavioral boundaries.

At the core is a behavioral structured model based on stable human drivers such as values, motivations, risk tolerance, information preferences and decision patterns. Public signals, domain knowledge and structured inputs are translated into measurable behavioral dimensions. These dimensions define how a target group processes information and reacts to strategic choices in a specific scenario. Each model uses weighted variables. This means behavioral traits are calibrated. The same audience model can therefore react differently depending on the scenario, while still staying consistent in its underlying logic.

When users test a concept, the language model generates responses within these predefined parameters. It does not “invent” a personality. It executes the decision logic defined by the behavioral framework. This hybrid architecture combines generative AI with structured behavioral weighting. The result is consistent, context-aware simulation of likely audience reactions across communication and event scenarios.

The System is designed as a scalable and repeatable framework that can be applied across industries, event formats and international markets without requiring custom AI development for each use case.

Questions / Answers

What specific problem does this AI solve?
Digital Doppelgänger address a strctural problem in events and communication design: critical decisions are made before organizations truly know how their audiences will react.

In most projects, formats, messages, experience concepts and budgets are often defined based on internal assumptions, past experience or limited research. Reliable feedback usually becomes available only after execution when changes are expensive or no longer possible. Alternatively, traditional research methods require significant time and financial investment and still provide only partly insights into behavior in specific scenarios.

As a result, teams plan under uncertainty reyling on assumptions, internal opinions and interactive trial-and error. They debate internally which version will work better, which elements might create friction, and how different audience types will respond. Many high-impact decisions are made without reliable behavioral evidence. Digital Doppelgänger reduce this uncertainty. They allow to simulate likely audience reactions before execution. Instead of guessing, organizations can test strategic options in advance and make more confident decisions before committing significant resources.

What makes your approach different or innovative?
Digital Doppelgänger introduce a new category of AI in events: pre-decision simulation. They are innovative because they use AI to simulate decisions before they are made.

While most AI tools in events focus on content generation or automation, Digital Doppelgänger focus on decision intelligence. The key innovation lies in combining large language models with a structured, psychologically grounded behavioral mode.

Instead of asking a general AI to “act like” a target group, we build calibrated audience models with defined values, motivations and decision patterns. These behavioral parameters guide the AI. The language model executes predefined decision structures. This ensures consistency, explainable and behaviorally grounded output instead of generic outputs.

The system is also interactive and scenario-based. You can dynamically test different strategic variations in real time and immediately see how reactions change depending on context, tone or format. This creates a new operational layer between strategy and execution, where decicsions can be tested before they are implemented.

By shifting decision-making from assumption to simulation, Digital Doppelgänger address one of the most fundamental inefficiencies in the event industry and redefine how strategic planning is approached.

VALIDATION

Questions / Answers

How did you test, validate, or quality-check the AI outputs to ensure they were accurate, safe, or reliable?
Digital Doppelgänger were tested and validated through a structured, multi-layered process combining academic collaboration, expert review and real-world scenario testing. The goal was to ensure accuracy, stability and realistic audience simulation.

The behavioral modeling framework was developed in collaboration with academic partners and AI experts from the University of Wuppertal. Their expertise in marketing science and AI-driven synthetic market research supported the design, calibration and validation of the models. This ensured that core dimensions such as values, motivational drivers, decision logic and contextual sensitivity were grounded in established theory rather than assumptions. Validation took place on several levels.

First, structural validation. The weighted behavioral dimensions were continuously refined to ensure internal consistency and logical coherence. We tested whether outputs remained stable when variables changed. This ensured that responses followed the defined motivational logic and did not drift unpredictably.

Second, comparative scenario validation. The models were applied retrospectively to past communication and event projects. Simulated reactions were compared with documented real-world outcomes. Instead of feeding post-event data into the system, we replicated scenarios and checked whether the simulated behavior plausibly matched known results.

Third, expert review. Industry specialists and client-side stakeholders with deep audience knowledge reviewed the outputs. They evaluated whether the simulated reactions realistically reflected known audience characteristics. Their feedback was used to recalibrate weightings and contextual sensitivity.

Fourth, identity-based validation. In controlled settings, Digital Doppelgänger were built to reflect real individuals within an organization. These individuals reviewed the simulated responses and assessed whether they aligned with their own decision patterns and preferences. This created a direct qualitative benchmark for behavioral accuracy.

In addition, system-level safety checks were implemented. The structured behavioral layer constrains the generative AI component, reducing arbitrary outputs and ensuring responses stay within defined parameters. Through academic grounding, iterative calibration, expert validation and controlled real-person testing, Digital Doppelgänger were systematically refined to deliver consistent, plausible and decision-relevant simulations.

IMPACT
In one summary, explain the overall impact of your AI solution. Please cover four areas: innovation, execution, user or customer outcomes, and measurable results.

Questions / Answers

Innovation

Digital Doppelgänger redefine how AI is used in event and communication strategy: to simulate decisions before they are made. This changes how communication and event strategies are developed.

Most AI applications in this field focus on automation, analytics or content generation. Digital Doppelgänger shift the focus to decision foresight. They add a simulation layer between strategy and execution, allowing organizations to explore likely consequences before committing resources. This fundamentally changes planning processes. The innovation is not only technical, but procedural. Audience understanding shifts from a retrospective insight to a proactive decision tool used before execution. It becomes a proactive decision tool used during the strategic phase. Instead of analyzing reactions after the fact, teams can explore likely behavioral dynamics before execution. This creates a new form of anticipatory intelligence.

Behavioral science is translated into a usable system. Values, motivations and contextual sensitivities are no longer theoretical insights, they become operational variables that guide decision-making. The approach also challenges traditional research models. Surveys and focus groups are static and episodic. Digital Doppelgänger are dynamic and scenario-based. Teams can test variations in real time and observe how small strategic changes influence likely outcomes.

As a result, audience insight is no longer a one-time research step. It becomes an ongoing simulation capability embedded in the planning process. By repositioning AI from automation tool to strategic simulation engine, Digital Doppelgänger establish a new working model for communication and event design, one based on foresight rather than assumption or correction.

Execution

The Digital Doppelgänger system is designed for real-world application and scalability. The system translates a complex behavioral framework into a practical, scalable workflow that teams can apply without technical barriers. Implementation follows a clear and repeatable process: structured input collection, contextual calibration, behavioral model configuration and scenario-based simulation. Each step is documented and reproducible, ensuring consistency across industries and use cases. The models are pre-structured and do not require custom AI development for each project. This allows efficient deployment while maintaining methodological rigor.

A key principle is controlled adaptability. The core behavioral architecture remains stable, while contextual factors such as event type, audience composition or communication format can be adjusted without destabilizing the model. This ensures flexibility without compromising reliability. Digital Doppelgänger have already been used in complex, high-stakes environments, including large-scale brand experiences and international trade shows. In these contexts, the system supported strategic refinement before execution and proved capable of operating under real-world time pressure and complex decision environments.

Internally, the workflow includes structured expert reviews and calibration loops to maintain stability and consistency. The combination of predefined modeling architecture, contextual flexibility and iterative refinement ensures that Digital Doppelgänger are executable and repeatable systems ready for enterprise use.

The system has already been applied in real client environments, where it directly enfluenced strategic decisions before execution.

Questions / Answers

Outcome

Digital Doppelgänger enable faster, more confident and better-aligned decision-making before resources are committed. The result is better decisions made earlier with less internal debate and less risk.

Instead of arguing over assumptions, you can test alternatives in a structured way and directly see how likely audience reactions change under different conditions. This reduces subjective bias and replace opinion-driven discussions between strategy, creative and leadership teams with structured, evidence-informed evaluation. Clients report improved stakeholder alignment. When behavioral reactions become visible, it is easier to justify strategic choices, prioritize investments and remove elements that add complexity without increasing impact. Concepts become more focused and communication strategies clearer.

Decision cycles are significantly shortened,with teams reducing decision time by up to 30%, as you can test and validate options instantly instead of relying on additional research or prolonged internal alignment. Strategic direction is clarified before production begins. Creative quality improves as ideas are tested and refined before execution. Tone, sequencing, format and activation logic can be refined before execution. Creativity becomes more intentional and strategically grounded. Early applications show measureable improvements in decision speed, alignement and budget effieciency across complex event environments.

Digital Doppelgänger also deepen audience understanding. Instead of working with broad segments, teams can design for distinct behavioral types. This enables more relevant, “made-for-me” moments that resonate with specific motivations. The system helps correct planner bias by reflecting audiences as they are, not as they are assumed to be. Blind spots in strategic design become visible.

Importantly, the approach includes audiences who are less vocal or less likely to engage. It supports more inclusive and effective experience design. The models also surface underlying motivations that participants may not explicitly articulate. Because expressed preferences are often influenced by cognitive biases or social norms, they do not always reveal true drivers of behavior. By modeling decision dynamics rather than relying only on self-reported input, these latent factors become visible and usable.

Over time, repeated use strengthens organizational learning and strategic intuition. The overall outcome is a shift from assumption-driven planning to structured, behavior-informed decision-making. Organizations can address diverse audience needs without losing strategic focus and design coherent experiences with greater confidence.

Results

Digital Doppelgänger deliver measurable improvements in decision speed, planning efficiency and resource allocation. Projects require up tp 30% fewer concept interations, as weaker options are identified and eliminated earlier in the process. Clients report up to 25% faster internal alignment and a significant reduction in late-stage changes.

In large-scale event and brand experience contexts, the solution reduced the number of strategic concept iterations before final approval. You reached a preferred direction more quickly, shortening alignment phases and minimizing structural changes late in the process. This led to more efficient planning and fewer production adjustments. In trade show and live communication environments, simulation-based pre-testing identified elements that were unlikely to activate audiences as intended. By adapting or removing these components before execution, clients avoided unnecessary production costs and redirected budgets toward higher-impact elements. This also increased audience relevance, as formats deciand content were aligned with real behavioral drivers rather than assumptions.

Digital Doppelgänger also improved prioritization. When multiple formats or narrative approaches were being considered, simulations enabled earlier elimination of weaker variants. This reduced uncertainty and allowed earlier commitment to execution pathways. Clients reported increased internal confidence when presenting strategies to executive stakeholders. Because simulated audience reactions were available in advance, recommendations were supported by structured behavioral logic rather than creative argument alone. This strengthened credibility at board and senior management levels.

Qualitative feedback consistently indicates faster sign-off processes, stronger cross-functional alignment and greater robustness of final concepts. While specific metrics vary by project, clients report measurable reductions in iteration cycles, planning time and late-stage adjustments, alongside more efficient budget allocation. In high-budget environments, even small improvements in concept precision translated into meaningful cost savings and reduced downstream correction effort. Across applications, Digital Doppelgänger consistently reduce strategic risk, shorten decision cycles and improve the allocation of financial and creative resources before execution.

Questions / Answers

CASE STUDY

Describe how the AI was used in practice.
Digital Doppelgänger were used in real, high-stakes communication and event projects to test strategic decisions before execution. The following two cases show how the system worked in practice: a strategic enterprise event and a major international trade show presence. In both cases, the process started with a structured analysis of existing material, including client briefings, objectives, target group definitions, key messages and format concepts. This was complemented by contextual research to move beyond formal audience labels and identify the real decision logics behind the target groups. These logics were translated into structured behavioral variables within the model, allowing consistent simulation across different scenarios.

In the enterprise event case, the system translated a broad and formal target group into two clear decision perspectives. One focused on proof, governance, scalability and internal legitimacy. The other focused on strategic insight, intellectual relevance and long-term positioning. These behavioral models were then used to simulate how each perspective would interpret the planned dramaturgy, key messages, interaction formats and call to action. Through iterative testing, argumentation was sharpened, sequencing was optimized and critical elements were refined before execution. Because each simulation run followed the same model architecture, changes in output reflected contextual adjustments rather than subjective reinterpretation.

In an international trade show case, Digital Doppelgänger were applied to evaluate a complex exhibition stand with multiple exhibits, open visitor flow and diverse stakeholder roles. Two dominant decision logics were modeled: one prioritizing evidence, reliability and accountability, and another emphasizing efficiency, system performance and economic impact. The simulation tested how these perspectives would navigate the stand, interpret exhibits and assess overall narrative coherence. This made it possible to clearly identify which elements built trust and strategic relevance, and which required clearer operational grounding.

Digital Doppelgänger enabled you to replace abstract audience assumptions with structured behavioral evaluation before committing to final production.

What measurable results or improvements did it deliver?
(Include any evidence that shows real-world impact.)

Digital Doppelgänger improved strategic precision, accelerated decision-making and reduced risk before execution. Across projects, teams reached clearer decisions faster and with fewer late-stage corrections.

In the enterprise event case, the most visible improvement was the shift from a broad target group description to a structured, decision-oriented audience model. This increased the precision of strategic evaluation. Argumentation became sharper, proof elements more visible, interaction formats more aligned with audience expectations and the call to action more clearly embedded in a coherent decision journey. As a result, fewer concept iterations were required and executive-level alignment was achieved more quickly.

In the trade show case, Digital Doppelgänger transformed the stand from a collection of individual exhibits into a coherent business argument. The simulation revealed where strategic value was strong across decision perspectives and where future-oriented elements lacked operational clarity. This enabled earlier prioritization and more focused budget allocation before production decisions were finalized.

Across applications, four measurable patterns emerged: First, fewer late-stage concept revisions due to earlier stress-testing of strategic assumptions. Second, shorter internal alignment cycles driven by structured decision logic instead of subjective debate. Third, more precise budget allocation toward elements with higher simulated impact. Fourth, greater executive confidence when presenting strategic choices, supported by transparent behavioral reasoning. The consistent result was a structural improvement in decision-making: more efficient allocation of both budget and creative resources, stronger prioritization and reduced pre-execution risk.

Importantly, these improvement patterns appeared across different contexts. While specific results varied depending on the project, the underlying modeling approach proved both robust and adaptable to different environments. Digtial Doppelgänger transform event planning from a reactive discipline into a predivitive one.

MODEL TRANSPARENCY (optional)

Questions / Answers

What type of AI model or technique does your solution use? Please provide a simple, high-level explanation that helps judges understand the approach (no confidential or proprietary details required).

Digital Doppelgänger combine structured behavioral modeling with large language models. In simple terms: a defined audience logic guides a generative AI system to simulate how real target groups would decide in specific scenarios.

The system consists of two layers. First, a structured behavioral modeling layer. Second, a generative language model layer. The behavioral layer defines weighted psychological dimensions such as values, motivations, risk orientation, information preferences and decision patterns. These dimensions are organized into a stable configuration that represents a specific target group. This structured profile defines how the audience thinks and decides. It sets clear boundaries and response tendencies, ensuring that simulations remain consistent instead of varying randomly.

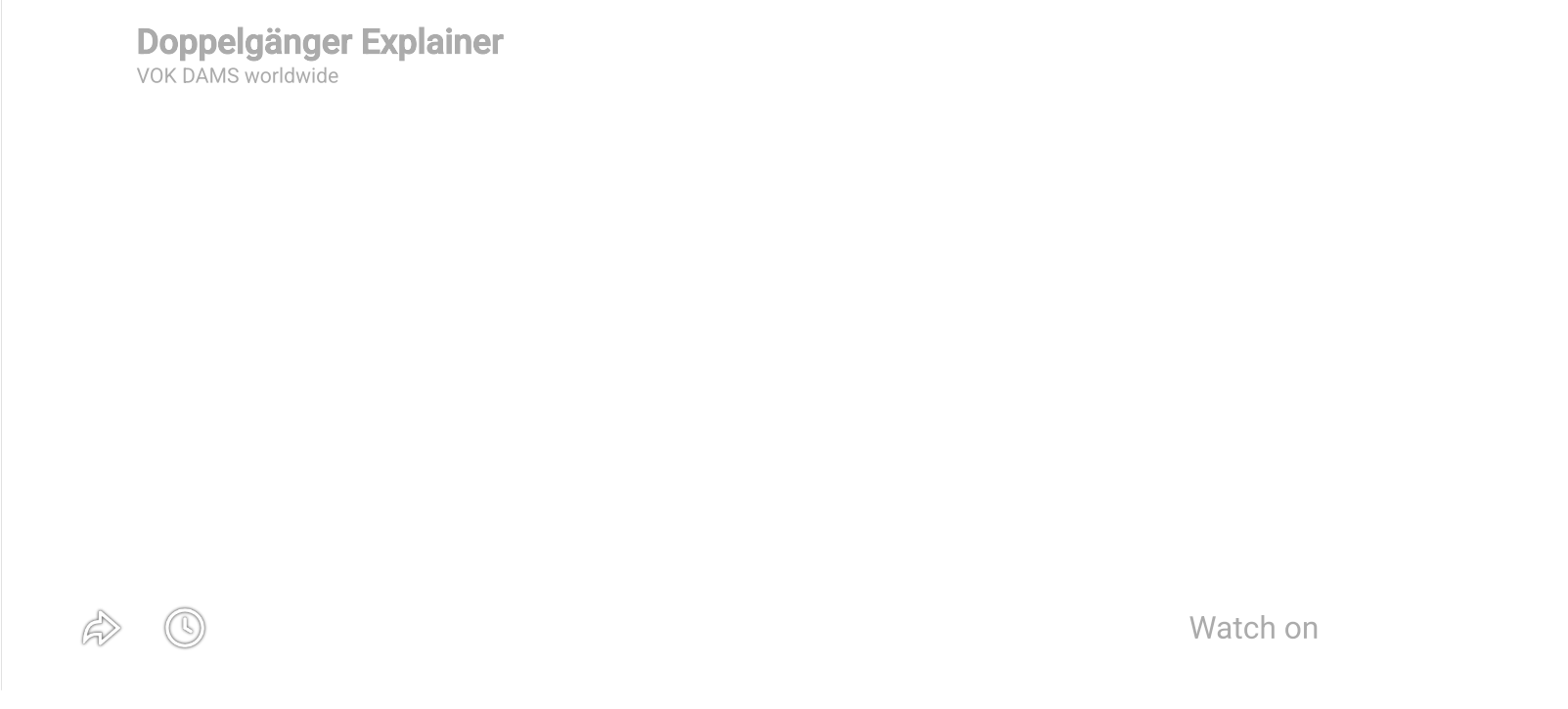
On top of this layer, a large language model (such as OpenAI, Google Gemini or Anthropic Claude) is used to generate scenario-based responses. The language model produces outputs within the defined behavioral framework. It functions as an execution layer, while the behavioral model defines the decision logic and evaluation criteria. Each simulation follows a structured input–evaluation–response process. This allows systematic testing of different scenarios rather than generating isolated outputs.

Because the behavioral modeling layer is independent from the underlying language model, the framework is system-agnostic. It can be deployed across different AI providers without changing the conceptual structure. Current implementations primarily use leading OpenAI models for performance and stability, but the framework has been successfully adapted to other major AI systems.

No proprietary training of foundation models is required. The innovation lies in structured configuration, contextual calibration and controlled simulation logic applied on top of existing generative AI infrastructure. This ensures portability, scalability and long-term adaptability as AI ecosystems evolve.

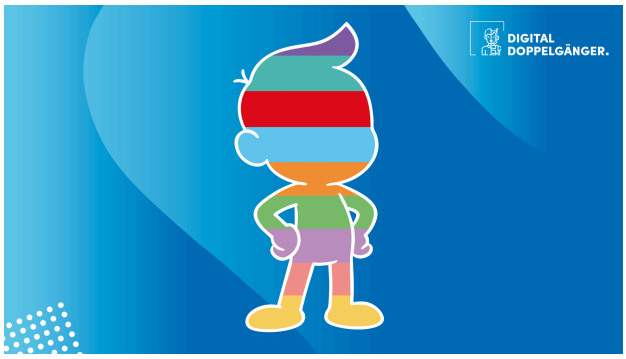
SUPPORTING MATERIAL

Video Link (optional)



Questions / Answers

1. Additional upload if required, screenshots, dashboards, examples, test results



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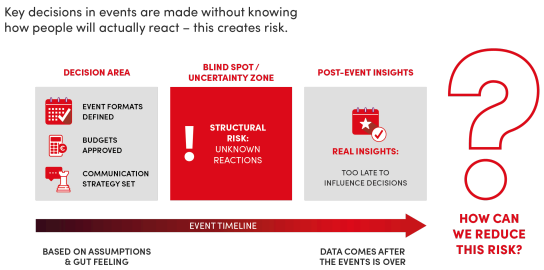

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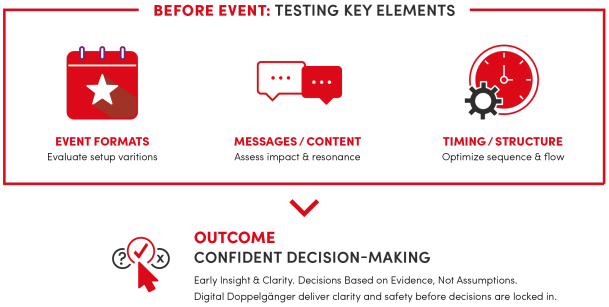

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Questions / Answers

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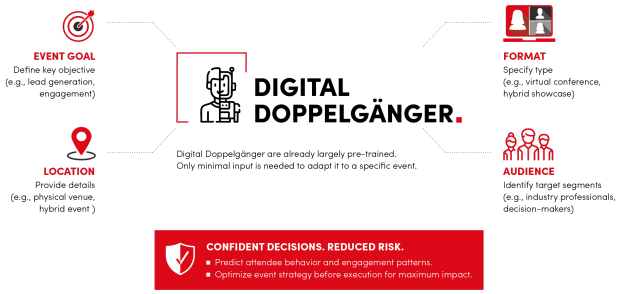

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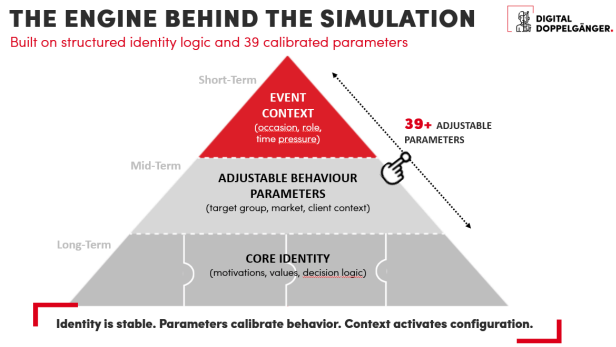

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DECLARATION FIELD

By completing this nomination you are agreeing to the terms and conditions and declare that this entry form is eligible for entry. You are confirming all facts and figures contained within are accurate and true.

I agree

Scoring

Un-pin scoring panel

Opt-out

Recuse yourself if you have a professional or personal conflict of interest

Scoring is incomplete ⚠ Save Cancel

Criteria	Score
Innovation * How original and forward-thinking is the approach? Whether you built an AI solution, adopted AI within your own events operation, or are bringing an early-stage concept to market, judges want to see genuine originality. Has AI been applied in a new or distinctive way? Does it solve a real problem creatively rather than following the obvious path? Look beyond off-the-shelf deployment and assess the quality of thinking behind the approach.	/ 100

Recuse yourself if you have a professional or personal conflict of interest

Scoring is incomplete ⚠

Criteria	Score
Impact * What difference has this made, or what difference is it credibly expected to make? For live solutions, look for concrete evidence -- engagement rates, time saved, revenue generated, cost reduction, satisfaction scores. For pilot or beta-stage entries, early indicators such as user testing results, pilot outcomes, letters of intent, or projected impact grounded in credible data are all valid. Strong entries will be specific, not vague.	/ 100
Execution * How well has this been implemented or developed? For suppliers and vendors, consider the quality of the build, the robustness of delivery, and how challenges were handled. For organisers, consider how well AI was embedded into operations and how the team managed change. For early-stage entries, assess the quality of the product so far, the clarity of the roadmap, and the credibility of the team's approach. Thoughtful, professional execution at any stage counts highly.	/ 100
Results * What has been achieved, and what does the evidence show? For established solutions, consider client outcomes, retention, testimonials, and industry recognition alongside hard metrics. For organisers, attendee feedback, operational improvements, and stakeholder satisfaction all count. For startups or beta entries, judges should look for credible progress -- pilot conversions, early user feedback, investment secured, or strategic partnerships -- and should assess potential alongside proven outcomes. Do not penalise entries for being early stage; reward evidence of meaningful progress and a clear path to impact.	/ 100
Total	-

Recuse yourself if you have a professional or personal conflict of interest

Scoring is incomplete

Criteria	Score

Feedback

Dictation disable

You speak: English

Text will be: **English**

Start dictation (20s)

Opt-out

Recuse yourself if you have a professional or personal conflict of interest

Scoring is incomplete

Save

Cancel